



### Are we prepared for deepfakes?

Deepfake videos are going to wreak havoc in society, yet we seem to be celebrating them. <https://digit.in/jun20-122>



### Doordash and pizza

Doordash advertised lower prices for pizzas so the owners made a tidy profit by ordering themselves. <https://digit.in/jun20-123>

# Time Travelling Tech?

## A look at really innovative technologies and gadgets that were way ahead of their time

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**A** not-so-long time ago in a galaxy not-so far-away, there existed some geniuses, who were so good at what they did, and so prescient in their thinking, that they were essentially ahead of their time. These are the stories of their inventions... Almost all of those mentioned here were total and utter flops, but had they come just a few years later, and with a few changes, they could have earned their parent companies billions! Instead all the get is a spot on this list of failures...

### THE NETMACHINE (2002)

Once upon a time, there lived a boomer (not derogatory, merely descriptive... honest!) who was so flabbergasted by the new fan-gled gizmos that companies were throwing in their faces, and was so confused by what to buy in shops so filled with options for computers, that said boomer was overwhelmed with confusion. Rather than try and learn something new, it was much easier to moan and whine about the good old days of less choice, and some other boomer somewhere decided that this was a perfect op-

portunity for capitalism to step in and make some money!

Tired of having to learn how to use a computer, or do a little work learning how to connect things up? Confused about what is inside a computer and don't want to learn enough to make a buying decision? Don't worry, that's what the Netmachine was made for!

You're going to have to watch a 9 minute sales pitch of the Netmachine to know more. We insist! – <https://digit.in/netmachine>

At least you will learn the origins of the Gen X and millennial Apple fanbois, with the “it just works” smirk (except they pay more for that simplicity rather than less like the Netmachine boomers). ;-)

Seriously though, this was the granddaddy of what would become the iPad, chromebooks, and tablets in general which were targeted at those who only use the internet casually.

### MOUNTED DISPLAYS

Most of us would think of Google Glass as one of the first to reveal a head-mounted augmented reality display, and that's largely accurate because of the augmented reality bit, and for consumers. However, militaries across the world have had helmet mounted displays that would do a lot of the same stuff as Google Glass much earlier.

However, if we're looking at head mounted displays – the VR type – then we have to go back to 1996, when Sony released a product called the Glasstron, which was very similar to a 1993 prototype called the Visortron that was never available for purchase outside of Japan. The Glasstron was obviously not as good as even the cheapest VR headset today, and in fact Google Cardboard using your own phone would put it to



Google Glass – are we ready for AR now?

shame, but in 1996 it was blowing people's minds. The idea was really no different at all from modern VR, and was definitely the marquee product that showed the world what was possible.

The Glasstron boasted dual 0.7 inch LCDs, an 800 x 600 resolution for each eye, and even came with a see through mode, which allowed users to adjust transparency, and thus, see their surroundings. There was nothing augmented reality about how it functioned, but this was also a proof of concept for AR, and the overlays that we expect from it.